

JOEL STEPHEN

Senior Frontend & Product Engineer · React · TypeScript · Next.js

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SUMMARY

Frontend and product engineer with 5+ years shipping customer-facing software, now building Opus, the agentic AI workflow platform at AppliedAI, an AI-native company. Ships the product experience around LLM-driven workflows: a multiplayer AI canvas and the platform's customer-facing surface, both on Next.js and React, plus a reworked n8n workflow editor. Owns UI/UX from Figma through production and pushes back when a design doesn't serve the user.

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Engineer · AppliedAI

Jun 2025 — Present

Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Built *Process Discovery* on Opus, AppliedAI's AI workflow platform: a multiplayer canvas (Next.js, React, Yjs CRDT, versioning) where enterprise customers co-edit their business processes to drive Opus's AI workflow generation.
- Led the fork of n8n and its rewrite into Opus's technical workflow canvas (TypeScript, Vue, node-graph editor, expressions engine).
- Ships features on *Opus-CX*, the customer-facing surface of the platform (Next.js, React, Zustand), built to enterprise software and technical requirements.
- Built custom, situation-based AI pipelines for Process Discovery on Anthropic and OpenAI models; integrated ElevenLabs TTS into the same surface.
- Partners with presales and customer-experience teams on customer-facing technical conversations and folds user pain points into UI work with design and product.
- Coached the frontend team in AI-tooling adoption and mentors junior and mid-level engineers; the team turns reusable patterns into shared skills.

Senior Software Engineer · Otani Trading FZCO

Jul 2024 — Feb 2025

Dubai, UAE

- Led project direction and frontend delivery on a new PWA mobile application: owned requirements scoping, planning, and DevOps decisions end-to-end (hosting, CI/CD, monitoring, Docker).
- Drove UI/UX directly in Figma with shadcn components to validate user workflows visually before committing backend investment.
- Trained and mentored junior engineers to keep the team shipping independently.
- Made data-layer technology calls: URQL/GraphQL on the client, Strawberry + Python on the backend.
- Embedded computer vision where the data justified it: trained YOLO v5 models and used OpenCV for object detection and tracking.

Software Engineer · Otani Trading FZCO

Sep 2023 — Jul 2024

Dubai, UAE

- Embedded with vendor, merchant, and admin user groups on *Project FMI*, a large-scale B2B platform; shipped 7 major features and many smaller workflow improvements driven by direct user requirements.

- Built backend APIs (FastAPI + Pydantic + Peewee, and GraphQL with Strawberry + DynamoDB on *Project Valit*) and matching UI prototypes (VueJS, RadixVue, shadcn) so workflows were testable end-to-end before going to users.
- Wrote end-to-end tests (Pytest, Cypress) to keep critical operational workflows safe for the users relying on them daily.

Junior Software Engineer · RIOT by Preowned Collective Portal FZ LLC

Sep 2019 — Feb 2023

Dubai, UAE

- Led implementation of cross-functional features on a customer-facing platform, including 3 payment gateways and multiple third-party integrations.
- Migrated data from a legacy platform to a new Node.js / ReactJS website — cutover from messy historic state to a clean operational pipeline.

SDE Intern · Alucor Limited

Jan 2019 — Jul 2019

Dubai, UAE

- Designed and shipped a Django web application to replace a critical Excel-based workflow: REST APIs, LDAP authentication, and event-driven front-end behaviour shaped by direct user feedback.

PROJECTS

- **Cursor for Product Managers:** full-stack agentic AI product for product managers; pitched to Y Combinator (X26 batch) and reached the top 10% of applications.
- **ScamShield:** open-source, on-device scam and phishing detection extension (Manifest V3, Chrome + Firefox); 1M+ domain threat feed matched locally and SERP safety badges; false positives tuned on a 1.09M-URL benchmark. [Chrome Web Store](#) · [GitHub](#)

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science Engineering (Hons) · BITS Pilani Dubai Campus

Aug 2015 — Aug 2019

- Capstone: TensorFlow / Python stock price prediction — full pipeline from data to model to operational signal.

SKILLS

Frontend: React, TypeScript, Next.js, JavaScript, Vue 3, NuxtJS, Zustand, Pinia, RadixVue, shadcn, Tailwind CSS, HTML5, CSS; Figma (UI/UX prototyping)

AI / LLM Engineering: Anthropic API, OpenAI API, custom AI pipelines, agentic workflow orchestration (n8n forked + extended), prompt engineering, RAG patterns, ElevenLabs TTS

Real-time & Collaborative: Yjs (CRDT), WebSocket, Server-Sent Events (SSE)

Advanced UI: Large-graph rendering, canvas performance, undo / redo correctness, virtualised lists, node-graph editors

Backend & APIs: Python (FastAPI, Django, Pydantic, Peewee), GraphQL (Strawberry, URQL), REST, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, SQLAlchemy), Redis

Applied ML & CV: YOLO v5 (training, production), OpenCV (object detection + tracking), TensorFlow (academic)

DevOps & Delivery: Hosting / CI-CD / monitoring ownership at project scale; Docker; Pytest, Cypress, Selenium; Git, GitHub, GitLab; JIRA, Figma, Confluence; Agile

Certifications: 16 listed on LinkedIn · AWS Cloud Practitioner (in progress)